other Permanent Members and some important countries. The text of the 123 Agreement was shared with them. India offered to send a political-level Special Envoy to China. [19] The possibility of collaborating with China in civil nuclear energy after the NSG waiver was also held out. Prime Minister Dr Manmohan Singh personally raised the matter with both Premier Wen Jiabao in Singapore in November 2007 and with President Hu Jintao in Beijing in January 2008. China could not claim, this time, that India had gone behind her back or painted her as a villain. When India's National Security Advisor M.K. Narayanan met Premier Wen Jiabao in Beijing in late September 2007, the Chinese were careful to underscore that it was China's strategic policy to improve ties with India, but did not raise the subject of the Indo–US nuclear deal. [20] In October 2007, at the Russia–India–China Foreign Ministers meeting, when this subject was indirectly brought up by External Affairs Minister Pranab Mukherjee in the context of access to affordable clean energy technology to meet India's commitments to climate change, Chinese Foreign Minister Yang Jiechi briefly alluded to China's wish to see India join the CTBT, but again skirted around the issue of the nuclear deal. [21] In New Delhi, the Chinese Ambassador used to talk about China's efforts to work for a consensus with the other NSG members on India's case. It sounded positive, but it soon became apparent that the word 'consensus', in China's negotiating lexicon, was tantamount to a Veto of One. There was a desire on both sides to maintain a publicly amicable relationship, while each was engaged behind the scenes in pursuing their strategy.

India reached out to the other NSG members in Vienna and their capitals, and learned of Chinese efforts behind-the-scenes to block the NSG waiver. Reasonable doubts were raised by many countries, including those like Japan which wished to be helpful. These included concerns about proliferation by